

OFFICIAL PROGRAMME

Merge Film Festival 2026



1–4 October 2026

MASSAGNO

5 October · Bellinzona · Outside the festival

Thursday

1 OCTOBER 2026

One evening on the big screen.

20:30

20:30–23:00 · CINEMA LUX, MAIN AUDITORIUM

CHF 15.– / conc. 10.–

Opening ceremony • Memory of Princess Mumbi

The festival opens and the film begins immediately afterwards in the same auditorium. One ticket for the whole evening.

Competition screenings, out-of-competition screenings, opening and closing ceremonies: CHF 15.– per event, CHF 30.– day pass.
Students and over-65s: CHF 10.– and CHF 20.–. All other events are free.
Accreditation includes one free seat per screening.

Friday

2 OCTOBER 2026

Private school masterclasses and workshops, the first two competition programmes, the discussion and the Swiss awards.

09:00	●	09:00–12:00 · CINEMA LUX, COSMO AUDITORIUM	Schools only
		Masterclass for arts high schools · Antonella Autuori (SUPSI)	
10:00	●	10:00–12:00 · CINEMA LUX, MAIN AUDITORIUM	CHF 15.– / conc. 10.–
		Out of competition · WALL·E	
		Andrew Stanton, Pixar, 2008 · 98 min.	
13:30	●	13:30–15:30 · CINEMA LUX, COSMO AUDITORIUM	Schools only
		Masterclass for science high schools · Stefano Peduzzi (SUPSI)	
13:30	●	13:30–15:30 · MASSAGNO MIDDLE SCHOOLS	Schools only
		Workshops for middle schools	
		Luca Botturi (SUPSI), Christian Montecchiani (SUPSI), Elena Battipede (SUPSI), Petra Mazzoni (SUPSI).	
14:00	●	14:00–15:30 · CINEMA LUX, MAIN AUDITORIUM	CHF 15.– / conc. 10.–
		In competition · Programme 1	
		Seven short films, ≈ 60 min. Followed by a Q&A with the directors in person.	
17:00	●	17:00–18:00 · CINEMA LUX, MAIN AUDITORIUM	Free admission
		FORMA APERTA · Where does the creative process live?	
		Open talk and launch of FORMA APERTA, with Felix Bachmann, Kevin Merz, Manuela Bachmann and Simona Gamba.	
18:30	●	18:30–20:00 · CINEMA LUX, MAIN AUDITORIUM	Free admission
		Discussion with Alessandro Bavari and Dario Cirrincione	
		WORKS ON SCREEN	
		Cronache di Mare	WORLD PREMIERE
		Artefatti	Raw War
		The Freakpoint Range	UNKNOWN QUANTUM OBJECTS
20:45	●	20:45 · CINEMA LUX, MAIN AUDITORIUM	Included with the Programme 2 ticket
		Swiss Innovator Award by Swiss AI Weeks · Swiss Press Award by linkfloyd	
21:00	●	21:00–22:00 · CINEMA LUX, MAIN AUDITORIUM	CHF 15.– / conc. 10.–
		In competition · Programme 2	
		Six short films, ≈ 60 min., with a Q&A with the directors in person.	
18:00	●	18:00–01:00 · MASSAGNO	Free admission
		Piazza del festival · Food and drinks	

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Accreditation includes one free seat per screening.

Saturday

3 OCTOBER 2026

The busiest day: three competition programmes, a roundtable, a panel on the environmental impact of AI, a talk and the Critics' Award.

10:00	10:00–12:00 · CINEMA LUX, MAIN AUDITORIUM Out of competition · Wider than the Sky Valerio Jalongo, 2025 · 83 min.	CHF 15.– / conc. 10.–
10:00	10:00–13:00 · MASSAGNO SCHOOLS, AULA MAGNA Roundtable · How is the image changing? With Alessandro Bavari and Marco Longo · CISA and USI.	Free admission
13:30	13:30–15:00 · CINEMA LUX, MAIN AUDITORIUM In competition · Programme 3 Eight short films, ≈ 60 min. Followed by a Q&A with the directors in person.	CHF 15.– / conc. 10.–
14:00	14:00–15:00 · CINEMA LUX, COSMO AUDITORIUM Roundtable · Work and the role of human beings in the age of artificial intelligence With Marco Zaffalon, Colin Porlezza (USI), Javisth Chabria and Pierre Alexandre Tremblay. Screening of The Interview by Mark Wachholz. Moderated by Felix Bachmann. In collaboration with USI.	Free admission
15:30	15:30–17:00 · CINEMA LUX, MAIN AUDITORIUM In competition · Programme 4 Eight short films, ≈ 60 min. Followed by a Q&A with the directors in person.	CHF 15.– / conc. 10.–
16:00	16:00–17:00 · CINEMA LUX, COSMO AUDITORIUM Panel: The environmental impact of AI With Prof. Silvia Santini (USI), Dr Marta Soprana (LSE IDEAS) and Elettra Fiumi. Moderated by Ilaria Espa.	Free admission
17:30	17:30–19:00 · CINEMA LUX, MAIN AUDITORIUM Talk · Javisth Chabria and Kevin B. Lee (USI) Moderated by Felix Bachmann. In collaboration with USI.	Free admission
21:00	21:00–22:30 · CINEMA LUX, MAIN AUDITORIUM Critics' Award by Filmexplorer and In competition · Programme 5 Seven short films, ≈ 60 min., with a Q&A with the directors in person.	CHF 15.– / conc. 10.–
10:00	10:00–01:00 · MASSAGNO Piazza del festival · Food and drinks	Free admission

Competition screenings, out-of-competition screenings, opening and closing ceremonies: CHF 15.– per event, CHF 30.– day pass.

Students and over-65s: CHF 10.– and CHF 20.–. All other events are free.

Accreditation includes one free seat per screening.

Sunday

4 OCTOBER 2026

The final out-of-competition screening, followed by the awards ceremony and a screening of the winning films immediately afterwards.

10:00

10:00–12:00 · CINEMA LUX, MAIN AUDITORIUM

Out of competition · title to be announced

We'll announce it soon.

CHF 15.– / conc. 10.–

15:00

15:00–16:00 · CINEMA LUX, MAIN AUDITORIUM

Awards ceremony and screening of the winning films

The awards are presented, immediately followed by a screening of the winning films.

CHF 15.– / conc. 10.–

Competition screenings, out-of-competition screenings, opening and closing ceremonies: CHF 15.– per event, CHF 30.– day pass.
Students and over-65s: CHF 10.– and CHF 20.–. All other events are free.
Accreditation includes one free seat per screening.

Monday

5 OCTOBER 2026

The day after the closing ceremony the festival travels to Bellinzona as a guest of the Swiss {ai} Weeks. This one is outside the festival programme: free, in another town, and with a sign-up of its own.

16:00

16:00 · PALAZZO CIVICO, BELLINZONA · COUNCIL CHAMBER

Swiss {ai} Weeks · Memoria Viva

Free · sign-up required

Stories, voices and archives in the age of artificial intelligence. Merge brings a best of the 2026 selection, and artistic directors Dario Cirrincione and Francesco Poloni are in the room.

PROGRAMME

- 16:00** Welcome and opening remarks · Gaetano Biondo
- 16:15** Biography Library · Claudio Brignole
- 16:45** From Giorgino to Memoria Viva · Roberto Mazzantini
- 17:15** Screening · Giorgino and the dragon known as Oblivion
- 17:30** Discussion

Registration required: luma.com/jhp0ct2s

Guest event, outside the festival · Free · sign-up required

Memoria Viva is organised by Mazzantini & Associati SA and Biography Library within the Swiss {ai} Weeks, under the patronage of the Città di Bellinzona. Sign-up is confirmed by the organisers.